Configure a Custom Domain in Microsoft 365 with Cloudflare DNS

Complete Step-by-Step Visual Guide

Based on real configuration screenshots

Domain used in this guide: jasvasolutions.bid

DNS Provider: Cloudflare

Platform: Microsoft 365 Admin Center

Services configured: Exchange Online (email), Basic Mobility & Security

This guide walks you through adding and verifying a custom domain, connecting it to Microsoft 365 services, and confirming DNS records.

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1. Prerequisites

Before starting, ensure you have the following:

• A Microsoft 365 tenant with Global Administrator (or Domain Administrator) privileges.

• Ownership of a custom domain (example used: **jasvasolutions.bid**).

• The domain's DNS hosted at Cloudflare (or another supported registrar that allows one-click authorization).

• Access to the Cloudflare dashboard for the domain.

• Existing users in Microsoft 365 that will use the new domain for email (recommended to prepare email addresses first).

Note: The screenshots in this guide show the exact flow for a domain managed by Cloudflare. If your DNS is hosted elsewhere, Microsoft may ask you to add records manually.

2. Add the Domain in Microsoft 365 Admin Center

Sign in to the **Microsoft 365 admin center** at https://admin.microsoft.com.

In the left navigation pane, expand **Settings** and select **Domains**.

On the Domains page you will see your default onmicrosoft.com domain (e.g., JasVASolutions.onmicrosoft.com).

Click the **+ Add domain** button (highlighted in the screenshot).

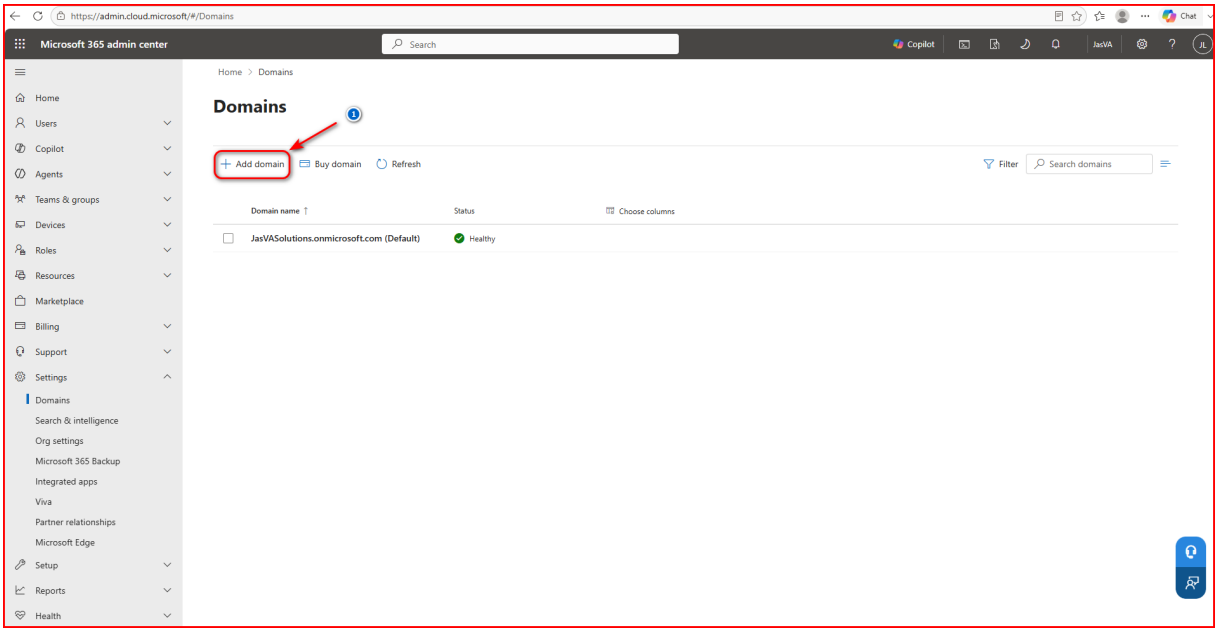


Figure 1 – Domains page in Microsoft 365 admin center

3. Enter Domain Name

The “Add a domain” wizard opens.

In the **Domain name** field, type your custom domain (example: **jasvasolutions.bid**).

Click **Use this domain** to continue.

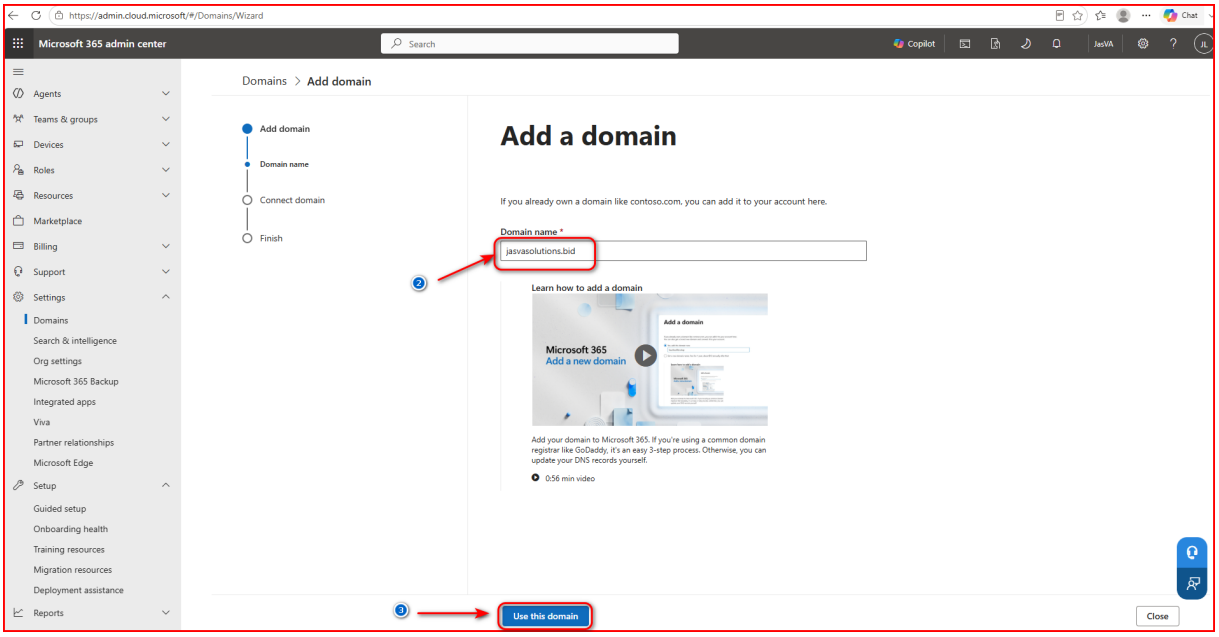


Figure 2 – Add a domain wizard – enter domain name

4. Verify Domain Ownership (Cloudflare)

Microsoft detects that the domain is hosted on Cloudflare and offers an automatic verification path.

The page shows “Sign in to Cloudflare”. Click the blue **Verify** button.

You will be redirected to Cloudflare to authorize Microsoft to verify ownership.

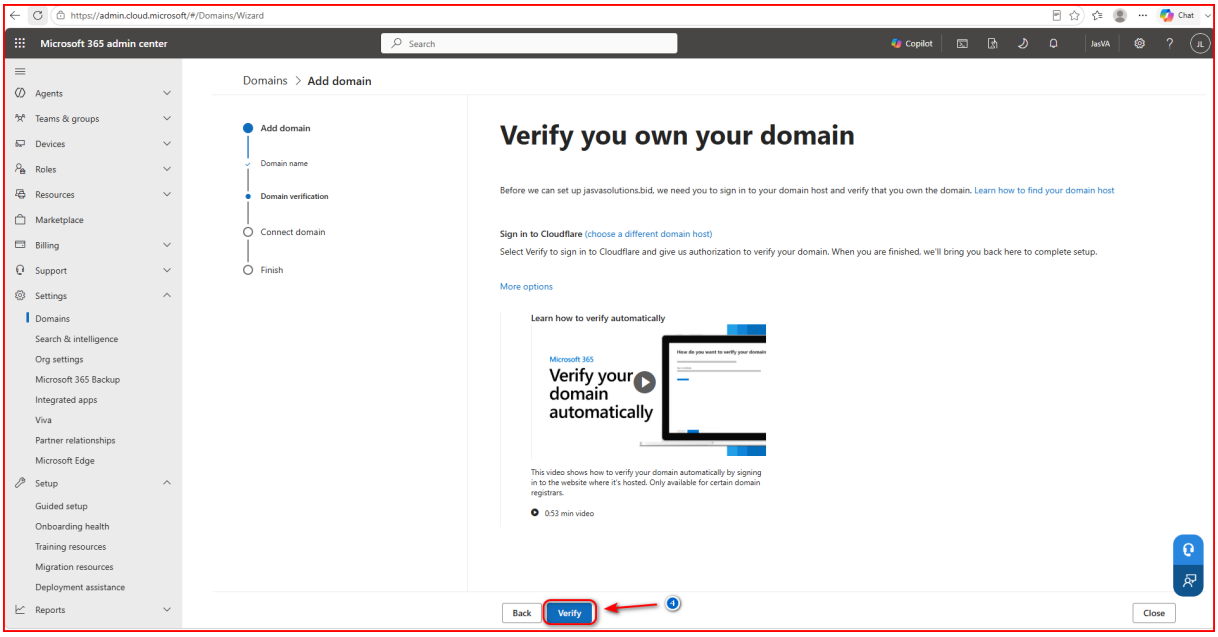


Figure 3 – Verify you own your domain

5. Authorize Verification TXT Record

A Cloudflare dialog appears titled “Authorize DNS records from Microsoft”.

It lists a single TXT record that Microsoft will add for verification:

• Type: TXT • Name: jasvasolutions.bid • Content: "MS=ms38571474" • TTL: 1 hr • Proxy: DNS only

Click **Authorize**. Cloudflare adds the record and returns you to the Microsoft wizard.

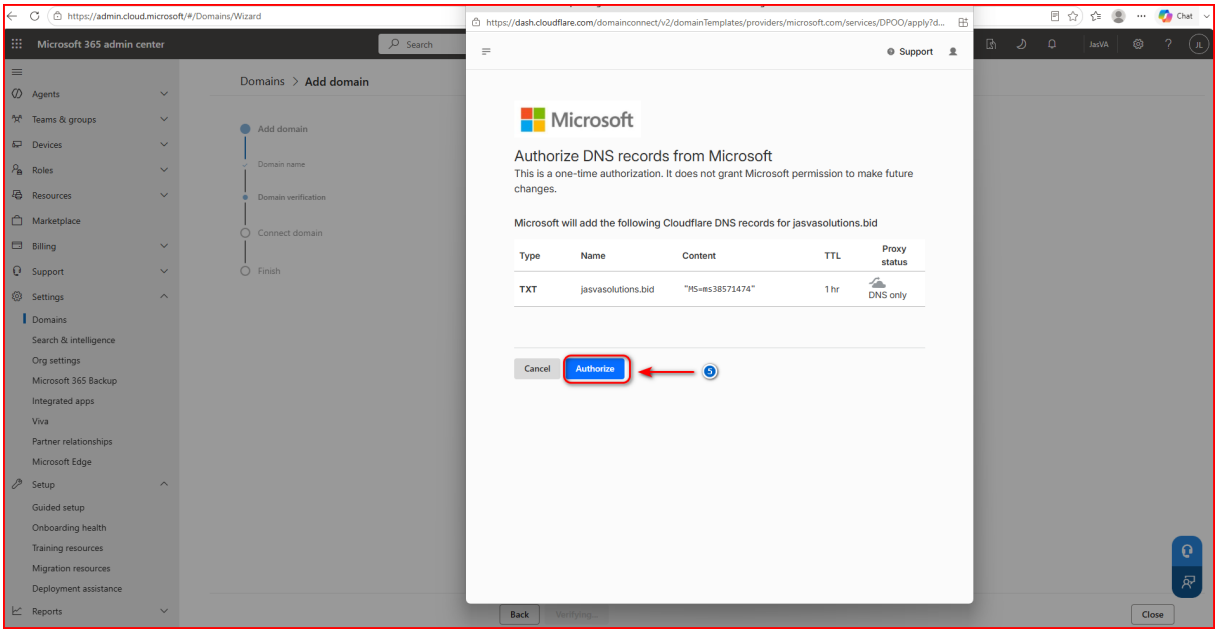


Figure 4 – Cloudflare authorization for verification TXT record

6. Choose Connection Method

After successful verification, Microsoft asks how you want to connect the domain.

Because Cloudflare is the DNS provider, the recommended option is “Let Microsoft add your DNS records”.

Click **Continue**.

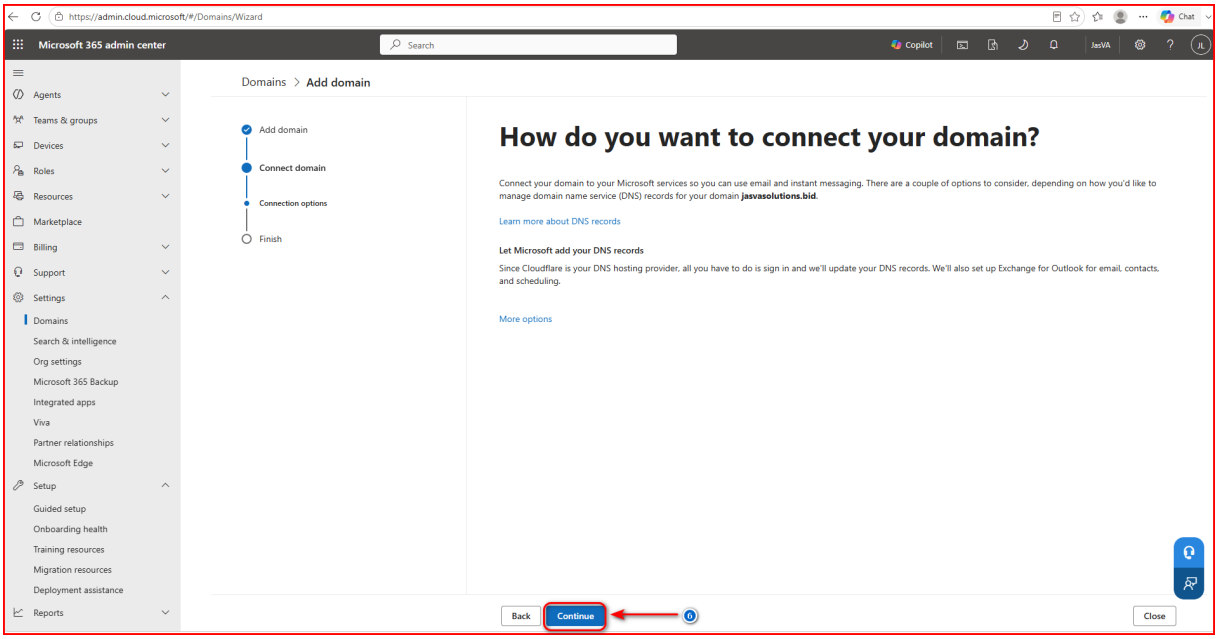


Figure 5 – How do you want to connect your domain?

7. Add Exchange DNS Records

Select the services you want to enable. In this guide **Exchange and Exchange Online Protection** is checked.

This will create the required MX, TXT (SPF), and CNAME (Autodiscover) records so that email works with Outlook and other clients.

Review the list of records that will be added, then click **Add DNS records**.

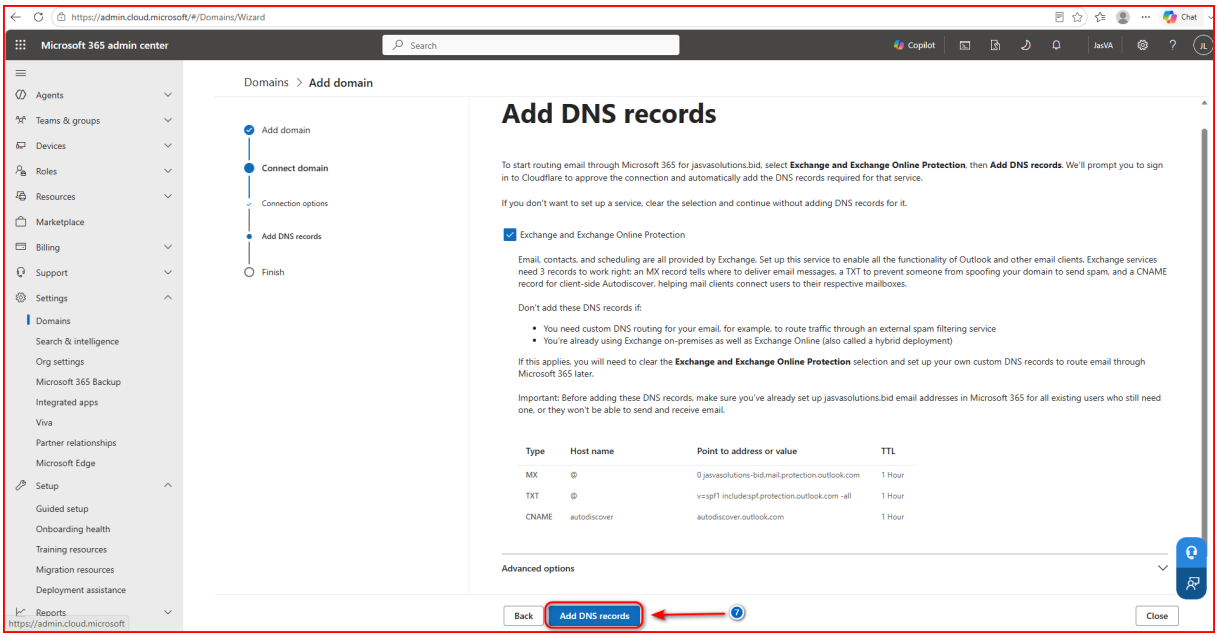


Figure 6 – Add DNS records for Exchange Online

8. Authorize Full DNS Records in Cloudflare

Cloudflare again shows an authorization dialog listing all the records Microsoft will create:

• MX → jasvasolutions-bid.mail.protection.outlook.com

• CNAME autodiscover → autodiscover.outlook.com

• CNAME enterpriseregistration → enterpriseregistration.windows.net

• CNAME enterpriseenrollment → enterpriseenrollment-s.manage.microsoft.com

• TXT SPF → v=spf1 include:spf.protection.outlook.com -all

Click **Authorize** to let Microsoft write these records into your Cloudflare zone.

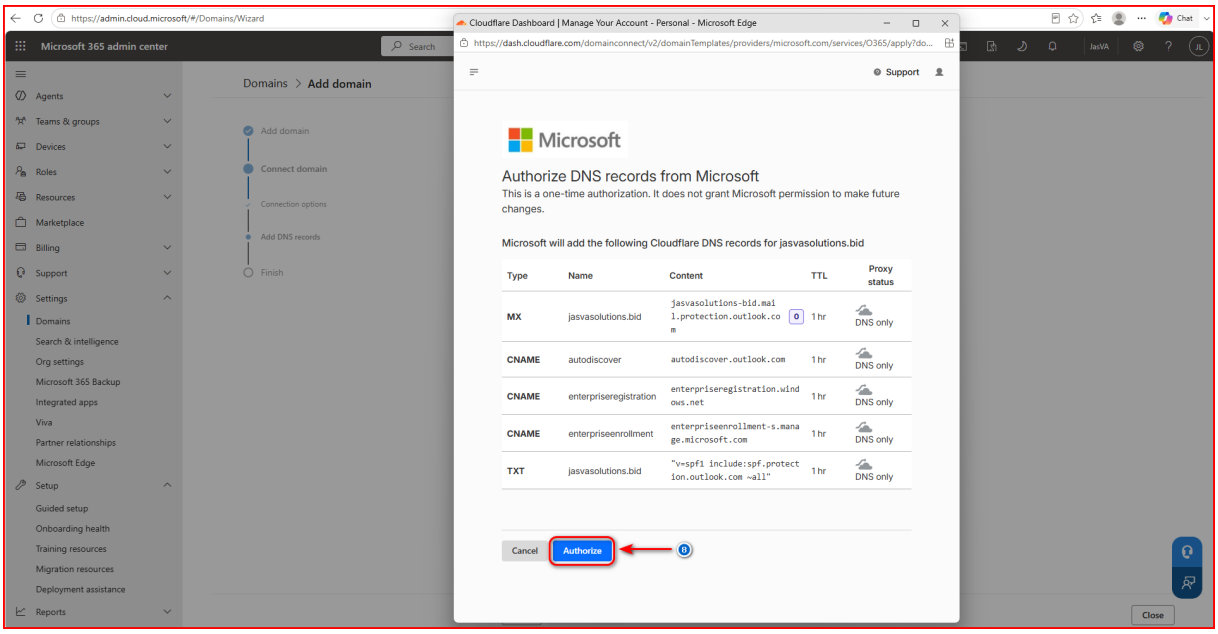


Figure 7 – Authorize MX, CNAME and TXT records in Cloudflare

9. Domain Setup Complete

Microsoft confirms that the domain is fully set up.

You can now go to **Active users** to assign the new domain to user email addresses and aliases.

Click **Done** to return to the Domains list.

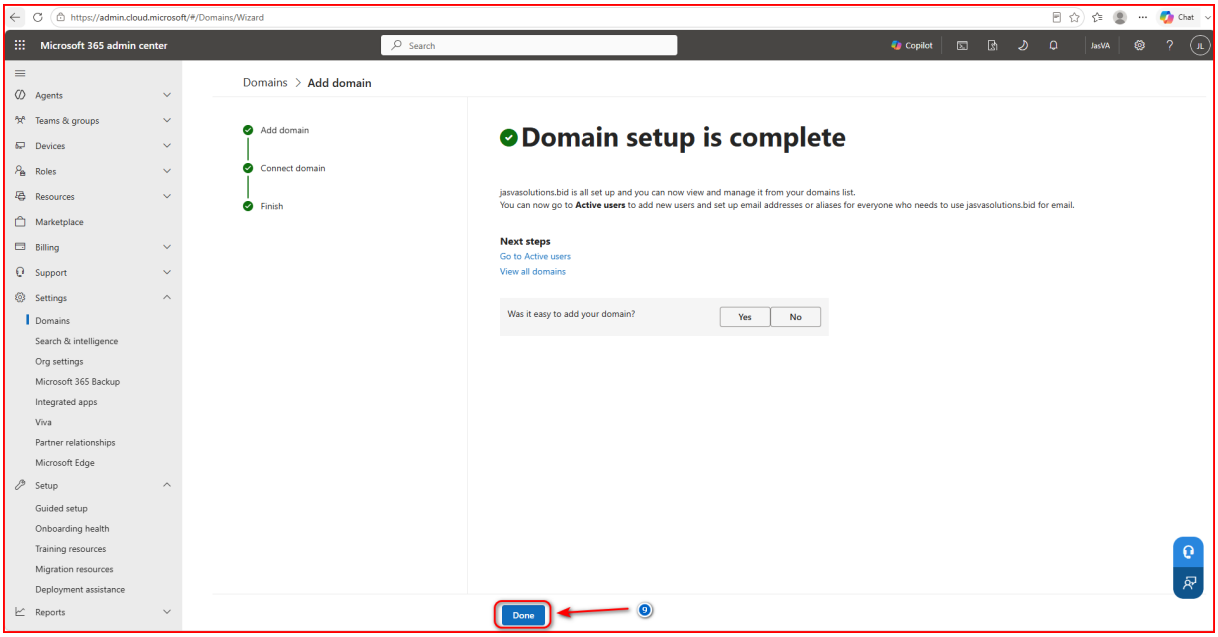


Figure 8 – Domain setup is complete

10. Confirm Domain Status

Back on the Domains page you should see your custom domain listed with status **Healthy**.

In this example it has also been set as the **Default** domain.

The original onmicrosoft.com domain remains available.

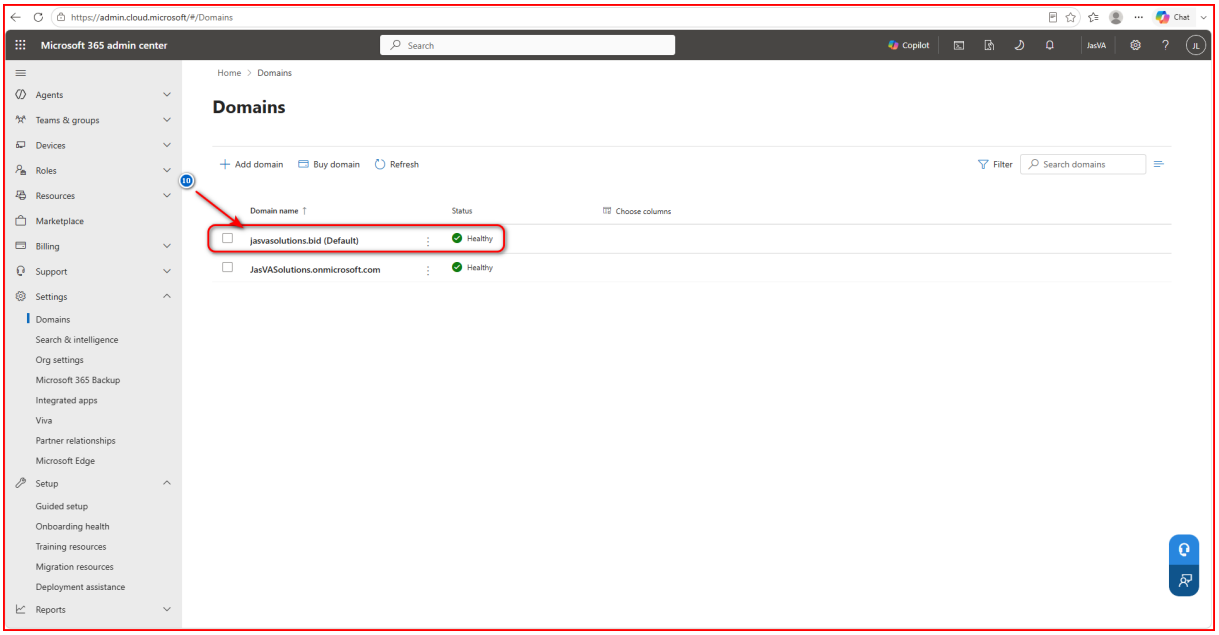


Figure 9 – Domains list showing the new domain as Healthy and Default

11. Review DNS Records in Microsoft 365

Click the domain name to open its details page, then select the **DNS records** tab.

All required records for Microsoft Exchange and Basic Mobility & Security should show status **OK**.

You can also download a CSV or zone file of the expected records if you need them for reference.

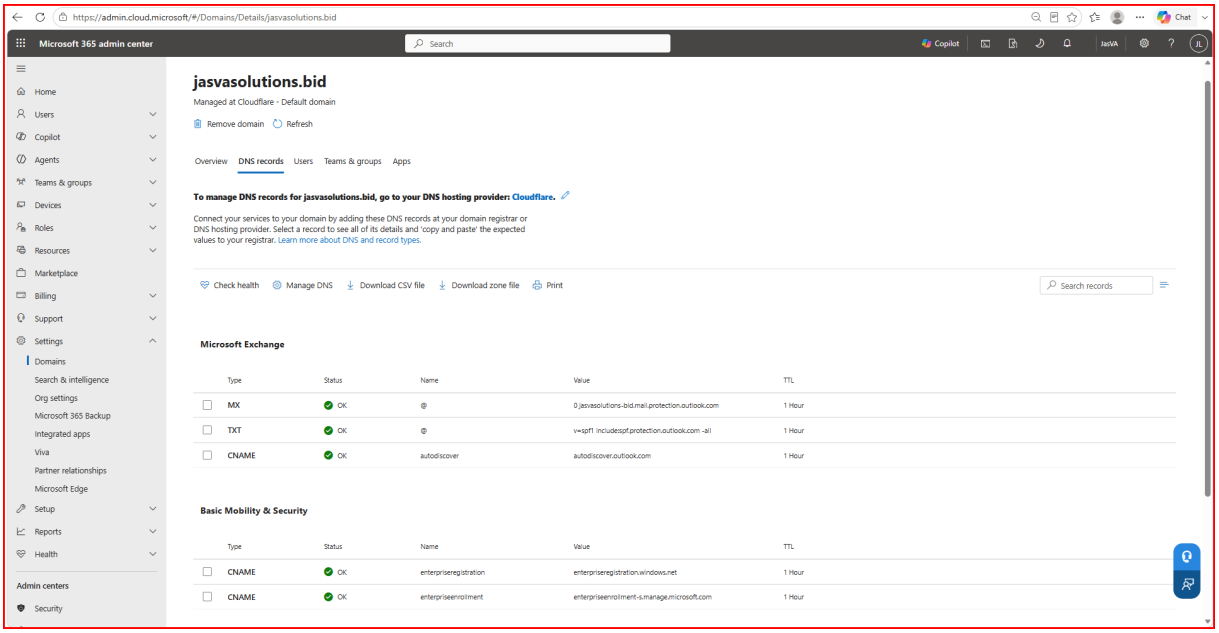


Figure 10 – DNS records view inside Microsoft 365 admin center

12. Review DNS Records in Cloudflare

Open the Cloudflare dashboard for the domain and go to **DNS** → **Records**.

You will see the records added by Microsoft, including:

• MX record pointing to the Exchange Online protection endpoint

• SPF TXT record

• Autodiscover and enterprise CNAME records

• DKIM CNAMEs (selector1 and selector2) – often added automatically or recommended

• A DMARC TXT record (recommended for email security)

All records should be set to **DNS only** (grey cloud) – do not proxy them through Cloudflare.

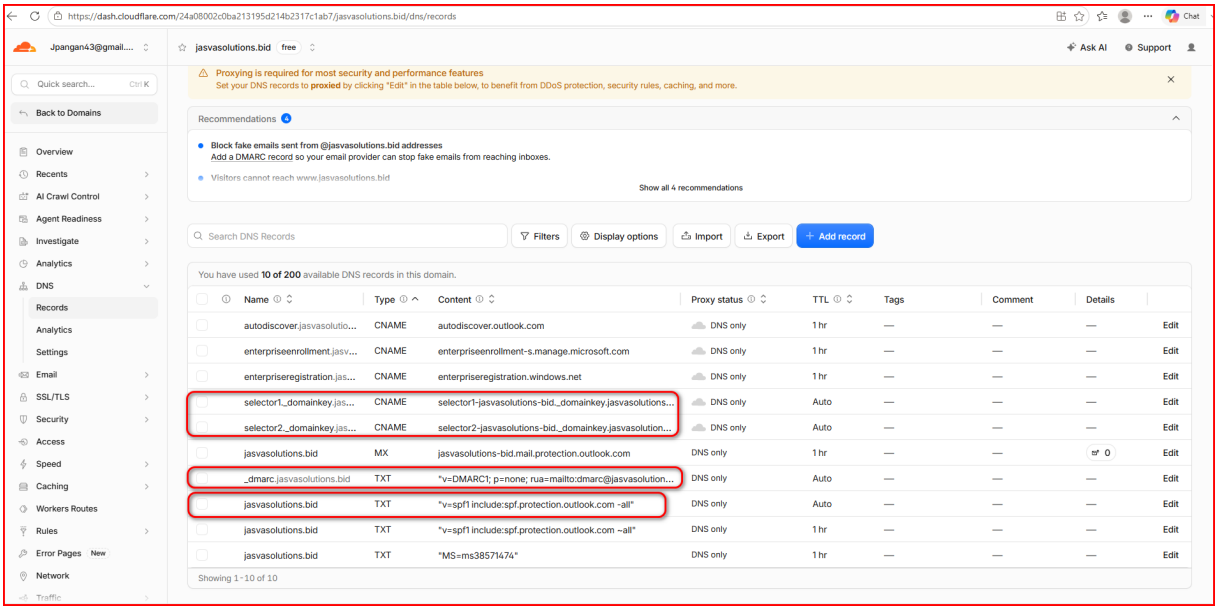


Figure 11 – Final DNS records visible in the Cloudflare dashboard

13. Next Steps & Recommendations

After the domain is healthy, complete these important follow-up tasks:

• **Assign the domain to users** – Go to Users → Active users and edit each user's email addresses / aliases to use the new domain.

• **Set the default domain** (optional) – On the Domains page you can make the custom domain the default so new users receive addresses on it automatically.

• **Enable DKIM** – In the Microsoft 365 Defender portal (security.microsoft.com) go to Email & collaboration → Policies & rules → Threat policies → Email authentication settings and enable DKIM for the domain. Cloudflare already shows the required CNAME records.

• **Configure DMARC** – Add or refine a DMARC record (example: `v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:dmarc@yourdomain.com`). Start with *p=none* for monitoring, then move to quarantine/reject.

• **Test email flow** – Send and receive test messages from external accounts and verify that SPF, DKIM and DMARC pass.

• **Update any external services** that reference the old onmicrosoft.com addresses.

Important: Never set the MX, Autodiscover, or SPF records to "Proxied" (orange cloud) in Cloudflare. They must remain DNS-only for Microsoft 365 email to function correctly.

End of Guide — Configure Custom Domain in Microsoft 365 with Cloudflare

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